# Chapter 1 Food Service Operation

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## Learning Objectives

- Get an insight into the scope of food service
- Gain knowledge on various food service outlets
- Understand the functions of food service operation
- Know the general etiquettes in food service operation

## 1.1 Introduction to Food Service Industry

A food service institution is one which plans, prepares and serves food in quantities far greater than those characteristic of usual home meals. The growth of food service industry from ancient times like the very simple "inns" or "chathrams" has evolved into a major industry in India. Food service industry or hospitality industry is growing tremendously worldwide due to the 3'T's namely, Tourism, Travel and Trade.

A food service operation provides food and beverages basically along with accommodation or lodging facilities for a price. So this industry comes under the service category where the customer is offered not only hospitality but a wholesome dining experience.

**Definition:** Food Service Management is a process of managing the food service operation, a place where a traveler can get food and accommodation. Food and drinks provided in a good ambience, aesthetically for a cost-effective price to the satisfaction of a customer is the basic objective of a food service operation. Safe and tasty food with quality served in a hygienic environment is important.

Today, a number of food and beverage operations have come up but the beginnings of food service was very small. The root of food service was very much in Indian customs, habits and characteristics of civilization. In medieval times quantity food production was followed in religious orders, royal households and places of education where it was traditional in India for students to live with the teacher or Guru for their education. Historically, the evolution of public eating places was stimulated by people's desire to travel and explore, initially for spiritual enrichment for which people went on pilgrimages to holy places, followed by other goals like education, work, health, sports and leisure.



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